CHANDNI SONI

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EXPERIENCE

THINKMOCHA LLC New York, NY
Founder — AI-personalized storybooks for kids *2022 – 2025*

- Built and launched an AI platform that generates personalized children's storybooks, owning user research, product, the Next.js and Express stack, and the generative pipeline for story text and illustrations.
- Delivered 50+ books in a pilot with a NYC preschool; 90%+ positive feedback from educators and parents, with the roadmap iterated directly from their input.
- Ran B2B outreach to schools and summer camps, validating demand for personalized, mission-driven content.

ENDLESS FRONTIER LABS, NYU Stern New York, NY
Venture Associate *2025 – 2026*

- Sourced and screened startups for the 2025–26 digital-tech cohort of a nine-month accelerator for massively scalable science and deep-technology companies.
- Advised portfolio founders on product strategy, go-to-market, and fundraising to reach milestone goals.

SERVERLESS INC. New York, NY
Senior Software Engineer — B2B cloud SaaS *2021 – 2022*

- Technical owner of billing: migrated legacy manual billing to an automated Stripe-backed system, from architecture through production operations, cutting billing processing time 98% and billing errors 95%.
- Designed and shipped a flexible tier-based subscription model with product, sales, and leadership stakeholders.

RAKUTEN — Rakuten Rewards, Unroll.me, Slice New York, NY / San Francisco, CA
Software Engineer, later Software Engineer II *2016 – 2020*

- Led backend development for Rakuten Dining, launching a new dining-rewards revenue stream with 10,000+ U.S. restaurants; built the API powering both the iOS and Android apps.
- Spearheaded a serverless proof of concept for Dining that showed a 90% infrastructure cost reduction; presented results to C-level executives, driving company-wide serverless adoption that cut overall infrastructure costs 80%.
- Increased Rakuten order completion 50% by shipping profile-based autofill in the purchase flow.
- At Unroll.me, shipped a rollup recommendation feature that doubled user reach, re-architected thumbnail generation to cut screenshot time 75%, and built a GDPR-compliant, auditable account-deletion system on AWS Step Functions.
- At Slice, took Slice Watch, a price-drop tracking Chrome extension, from concept to launch across the extension, backend services, and product website; featured in TechCrunch and Lifehacker.

EDUCATION

NEW YORK UNIVERSITY, Leonard N. Stern School of Business New York, NY
Master of Business Administration, Andre Koo Tech MBA *May 2026*

- Specializations in Entrepreneurship & Innovation and Management & Strategy.
- SVP, Student Government. Teaching Fellow, Power and Personal Influence.

UNIVERSITY OF MUMBAI, Thadomal Shahani Engineering College Mumbai, India
Bachelor of Engineering, Chemical Engineering; minor in Computer Science *December 2013*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Technical:** Node.js, TypeScript, Python, React and Next.js, AWS (Lambda, DynamoDB, Step Functions, API Gateway), Stripe, generative AI pipelines for text and image.
- **Hackathons:** Three-time Coding Dojo hackathon winner: an image-recognition shopping app for iOS, an event discovery platform, and an Arduino-based scoring system.
- **Other:** Dale Carnegie Course (2018). Led a National Service Scheme blood donation drive that set the ward record. Lifelong meditation practitioner.
- **Languages:** English (fluent); Hindi, Marathi, Marwari (native); Gujarati (conversational).